

Ubuntu 24.04 to feature Linux kernel 6.8



Ubuntu users are in for a treat as Linus Torvalds has officially announced the Linux kernel 6.8 on the Linux Kernel Mailing List (LKML). This version is set to be the General Availability (GA) kernel for the upcoming Ubuntu 24.04 LTS release, which means it will be supported for the entire life span of the distribution. This release is average in size compared to the previous one, and doesn't skimp on new features and improvements. One of the highlights is the experimental Intel Xe DRM driver, which is part of a range of hardware support updates that include AMD Zen 5, Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3, and more.

Laptop users, particularly those with Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Carbon (Gen 12), Acer Swift Go 14, and ASUS Expertbook B5, can expect improved performance during peak loads. Additionally, AMD Ryzen 7000 and 8000 laptops will see mitigations for radio frequency interference affecting Wi-Fi and GPU memory clocks. Networking enhancements in Linux 6.8 are set to boost TCP performance with many concurrent connections by up to 40%. Gamers will appreciate support for new controllers and gamepads, including Nintendo Switch Online controllers and the official Steam controller.

Other notable features in Linux 6.8 include new system calls, a deadline server mechanism, Rust kernel support for LoongArch CPUs, and enhancements to the KVM guest-first memory feature.

Linux kernel 6.8 is available for download, but users are advised to wait for their Linux distribution to officially package and update the kernel. Ubuntu 24.04 LTS users will have Linux 6.8 included by default, and it will also be backported to Ubuntu 22.04 LTS in the upcoming HWE/Ubuntu 22.04.5 LTS release.

AI's human-like traits and behavioural patterns are being studied

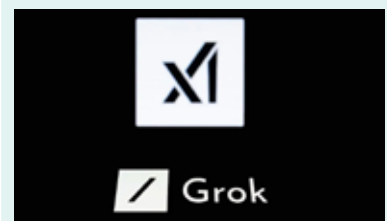
In a recent study by the University of Michigan (U-M), researchers employed 'behavioural' Turing tests, which assess a machine's ability to demonstrate human-like responses and intelligence, to analyse the personality and behaviour of various

Elon Musk open sources ChatGPT rival 'Grok'

Elon Musk has announced that his artificial intelligence startup, xAI, is open sourcing its ChatGPT competitor, Grok. This announcement came shortly after he filed a lawsuit against OpenAI, accusing it of deviating from its original non-profit mission in favour of a profit-driven model.

According to him, open sourcing Grok will allow the public to freely experiment with the technology's underlying code, aligning xAI with other companies like Meta and France's Mistral, which have open sourced their AI models. Google has released an AI model called Gemma, which external developers can adapt to their needs.

The debate over open sourcing in AI has been ongoing among tech investors, including OpenAI supporter Vinod Khosla and Marc Andreessen, co-founder of Andreessen Horowitz, especially since Musk's lawsuit against OpenAI. While open sourcing can accelerate innovation, some experts caution that open source AI models could be exploited by terrorists for creating chemical weapons or developing a super-intelligence beyond human control.



At last year's AI Safety Summit in Britain, Musk expressed his desire to establish a 'third-party referee' to oversee AI development firms and raise alarms if necessary. In pursuit of an alternative to OpenAI and Google, Musk founded xAI to develop what he termed a "maximum truth-seeking AI." In December last year, xAI introduced Grok to Premium+ subscribers of X.